

Defender Sheet

Bridge Habit Map

AUCTION

General

- ☐ Check vulnerability
- ☐ Use every bid to get info — partner + opps → HCP + shape
- ☐ Start from minimum length & min HCP promised — refine as bids land
- ☐ Bids not made are as important as bids made (e.g. passed → not 1 opener, no 6-card major)
- ☐ Remember conventions tend to show the bidder's shape / HCP
- ☐ By end of auction — summarise what you know about opps + partner

Lead prep (if you'll be on lead)

- ☐ Pick a tentative opening lead during the auction, not after
- ☐ Watch for lead-directing double opportunities on artificial bids

DEFENSE PLAN

Discipline

- ☐ Don't rush, don't get rushed — especially trick 1
- ☐ Have a reason for what you do

Count the points

- ☐ Add declarer + dummy HCP, subtract from 40
- ☐ Divide missing points using the auction
- ☐ If dummy is strong, give declarer minimum for their bid

Picture the unseen hands

- ☐ Build a hand-pattern for declarer (e.g. 3-5-3-2)

- ☐ Memorise your hand + dummy before playing

Count declarer's tricks

- ☐ Count declarer's distribution, HCP, and tricks
- ☐ No side-suit tricks for you? Look to trump (overruff, uppercut, promotion)

Identify the winning defense

- ☐ Which 2–3 declarer hand-patterns let you beat the contract?
- ☐ What suit does declarer fear?

Active or passive (binary)

- ☐ Long-suit declarer with a source of tricks → ACTIVE
- ☐ Balanced declarer, no obvious source → PASSIVE (don't break suits)
- ☐ Don't grab aces prematurely — aces capture kings

Opening lead (if on lead)

- ☐ Avoid suits opponents bid; favour unbid suits
- ☐ vs NT: 4th best from longest, or top of sequence
- ☐ vs suit: K from AK, top of doubleton; don't underlead an ace
- ☐ Trump lead if auction suggests a cross-ruff; not vs misfit
- ☐ Lead partner's bid suit unless you have a clear reason not to

Watch & remember

- ☐ Commit the first few cards from partner + declarer to memory
- ☐ Decide now which spot cards in which suits will matter